Virtually Safe

Debate Competition Report

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Online safety is no longer small concern but a fundamental human right deserving of robust debate and action to safeguard individuals and societies alike in this increasingly interconnected era .

About

As we increasingly rely on technology in our everyday lives, the question of online safety becomes more pressing.

In 2022, Virtually Safe carried out a research interviewing over 1000 young people and realized that young people below 18 years are involved with online betting, this led us to start the Safer Gambling Campaign and hosted a workshop and safer gambling hackathon in 2023.





As part of this campaign we are engaging young people in the conversation in the form of a Debate Competition as we believe that young people are an important part of the solution when addressing internet safety, and they have valuable expertise as ‘digital natives’ that can be shared.

Problem Statement

Online betting platforms has created a significant concern regarding its accessibility and potential harm to young people.

Young people are often financially inexperienced and may lack the resources to handle potential losses. Online betting platforms can exploit this vulnerability, leading to significant debt accumulation and financial stress.



Objectives

Critical Thinking: Debates encourage students to analyze information, identify strengths and weaknesses of arguments. Students will learn how to avoid harmful content and understand how to assess the credibility of online information, protecting themselves from manipulation and bias.

Research Skills: Debating online safety requires thorough research. By gathering evidence and learning to evaluate sources effectively, students will develop the skills to verify the accuracy of information they encounter online, safeguarding themselves from misinformation campaigns.





Communication Skills: Debates build public speaking skills, allowing participants to learn how to express their views on online safety issues in a constructive and respectful manner.

Listening Skills: Effective debating requires listening attentively to opposing arguments and identifying their key points. This will develop student ability to discern important information and assess potential online risks.

First Stage of Competition

The Application portal opened on the 1st April - 15th of June 2024. Students were asked to submit an essay on **how to prevent underage online betting** in not more than 500 words.



Second stage of Competition

Out of 164 applications , 15 students were selected to participate in an online debate competition. The fifteen students were to debate on the topic : **Combating Underage Online betting: The responsibility of parent or betting Companies.**



Top 15 Participants were

1. Adeyemi Odunayo Israel
Plateau State

2. Akinnuoye Michael
Ondo State

3.Akinloye Haneefah Olufunke
Oyo State

4. Stanley Daniel
Adamawa State

5.Balogun Taiwo
Oyo State

6. Adedipe Kehinde Shadrach
Ondo State

7.Ahmed fatimah
Kwara State

8.Adedipe Taiwo Sharon
Ondo State

9. Oluseun Testimony Oluwadunsin
Ondo State

10. ELOEMIE Nancy OMOLEGHO
Lagos State

11. Olisaekee Divine Ifechukwu
Kogi State

12. Olayode Ayomide
Osun State

13. Olatunde mary
Lagos State

14. Shaibu peace precious ufedo ojo
Kogi State

15. Balogun kehinde
Oyo State

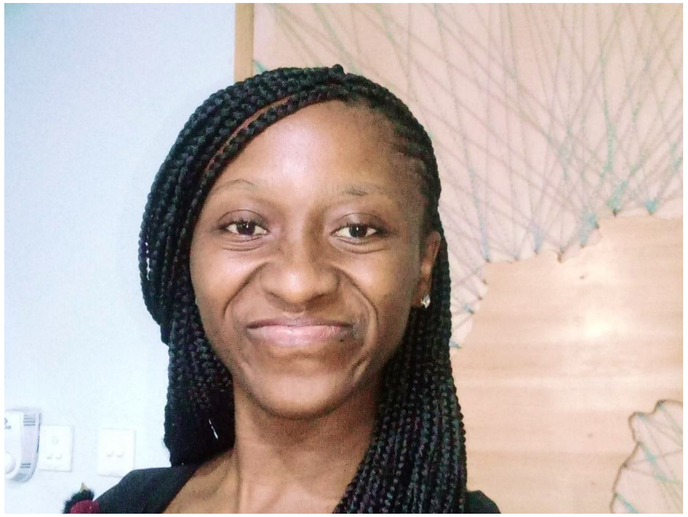
Panel of Judges



Fisayo Oke
CEO, Gamble Alert

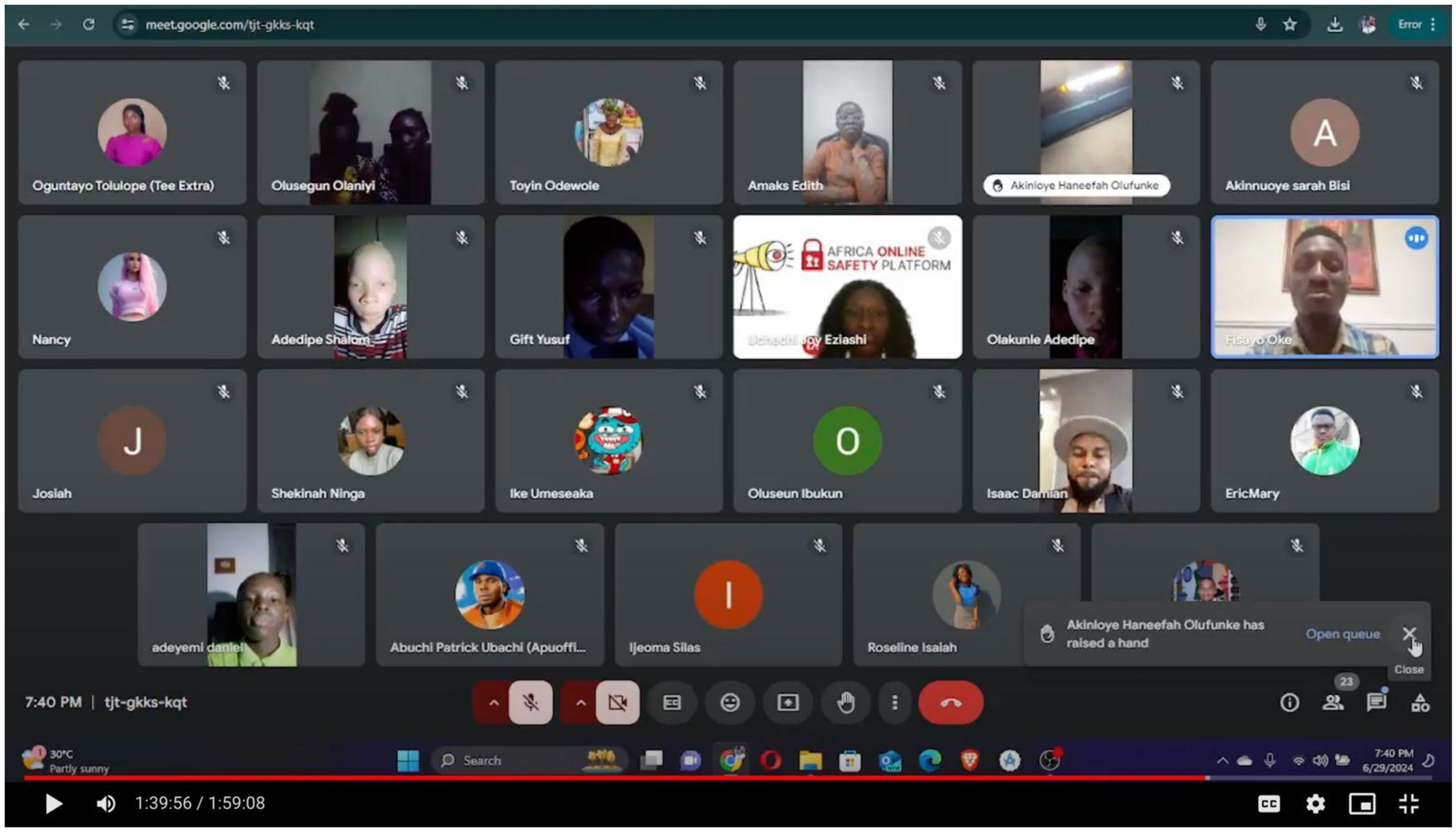


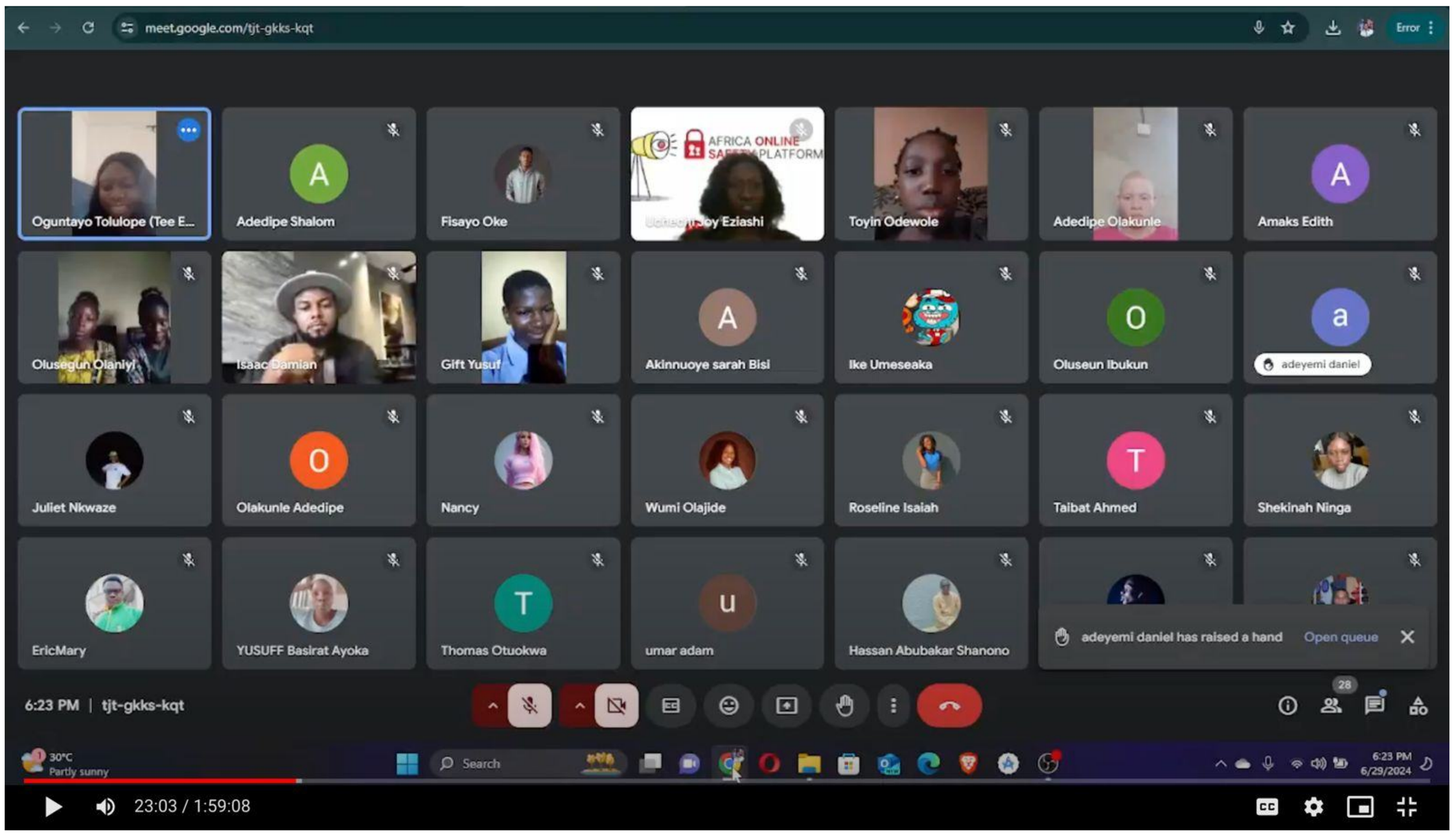
Chichi Umeseaka
Media Executive



Uchechi Joy Eziashi
Platform Manager - Africa Online Safety Platform

Virtual Debate (Top 15 Debaters)





Top 5 selection

Balogun Taiwo (Oyo state)

Oluseun Testimony Oluwadunsin (Ondo State)

Balogun Kehinde (Oyo state)

Shaibu peace precious ufedo ojo (Kogi State)

ELOEMIE Nancy OMOLEGHO (Lagos State)

Final Stage

The finalist from the second stage will be participating in the final stage at the Cyberspace Conference.



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